



Noukclass.com

PSAC Exam Practice Platform — Predicted Specimen Paper

2026

English

Paper 1 — Animal & Nature

Grade: 5 **Time allowed:** 1 hour 30 minutes **Total marks:** 56

Name: _____ **Class:** _____

Instructions to candidates:

1. Write your name and class in the spaces provided above.
2. Answer **all** questions in all four sections.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
4. The number of marks available for each question is shown in a box: 3
5. Read each question carefully before you begin to answer.
6. You may use a pencil for diagrams and rough work only.

Section	Marks available	Marks obtained
A — Reading Comprehension	15	
B — Grammar	20	
C — Vocabulary	10	
D — Writing	11	
TOTAL	56	

SECTION A — READING COMPREHENSION (15 marks)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

The Clever Dolphin

Dolphins are among the most intelligent animals in the ocean. They live in groups called pods, which can have up to thirty members. Dolphins use a special language of clicks and whistles to talk to each other. Scientists have found that each dolphin has its own unique whistle, just like a name.

Dolphins are excellent swimmers. They can leap high out of the water and spin in the air. They use this skill to spot fish from above. A dolphin needs to come up to the surface to breathe air because, like us, it is a mammal, not a fish.

Dolphins are very kind to each other. When one dolphin is sick, the others stay close and help it reach the surface to breathe. Many fishermen in Mauritius have seen dolphins swimming alongside their boats, as if they are playing a game. These amazing creatures remind us that the ocean is full of wonder.

1. What do dolphins use to communicate with each other? Give **two** details from the passage.

3

2. Why does a dolphin need to come to the surface of the water? Use a word from the passage to explain.

3

3. How do dolphins show kindness when one of them is sick?

3

4. Find a word in the passage that means **special or different from all others**.

3

Write a sentence of your own using that word.

5. Do you think dolphins are remarkable animals? Give **two reasons** from the passage to support your answer.

3

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (20 marks)

6. Fill in each blank with the correct article: *a*, *an*, or *the*.

5

- (a) My sister found _____ old book in _____ library.
(b) _____ elephant is _____ largest land animal.
(c) We saw _____ eagle flying over the mountain.

7. Rewrite each sentence, changing the verb in brackets to the correct form of the *simple past tense*.

5

- (a) The children (swim) in the lagoon yesterday.

- (b) The bird (build) its nest on the tall tree.

- (c) My father (catch) three fish this morning.

- (d) The dolphins (leap) high out of the water.

- (e) She (see) a beautiful butterfly in the garden.

8. Choose the correct preposition from the word bank and write it in the blank.

5

Word bank: above beside through during under

- (a) The fish swam _____ the coral reef.
(b) The cat slept _____ the warm blanket.
(c) Eagles fly high _____ the clouds.
(d) The puppy sat _____ me on the bench.
(e) The birds sang _____ the whole afternoon.

9. Tick (✓) the correct adjective to complete each sentence.

5

- (a) The dolphin has a _____ skin.
☐ rough ☐ smooth ☐ hairy ☐ sticky
- (b) The nest was made of _____ sticks.
☐ metal ☐ plastic ☐ dry ☐ cooked
- (c) The ocean was _____ after the storm.
☐ calm ☐ hungry ☐ sweet ☐ narrow
- (d) A pod can have up to thirty _____ dolphins.
☐ invisible ☐ clever ☐ noisy ☐ sad
- (e) The scientist made a _____ discovery about dolphins.
☐ boring ☐ dangerous ☐ remarkable ☐ tiny

SECTION C — VOCABULARY (10 marks)

10. Write the opposite of each word. Choose from the box below.

5

Box: *wild shallow ugly slow weak*

Word	Opposite
(a) tame	
(b) deep	
(c) beautiful	
(d) fast	
(e) strong	

11. Fill each blank with a suitable word from the box. Each word is used once.

5

Box: *intelligent habitat surface migrate predator*

- (a) A dolphin must come to the _____ of the water to breathe.
- (b) The lion is the top _____ on the savannah.
- (c) Many birds _____ to warmer countries during winter.
- (d) The rainforest is the natural _____ of many rare animals.
- (e) Dolphins are very _____ and can learn new skills quickly.

SECTION D — WRITING (11 marks)

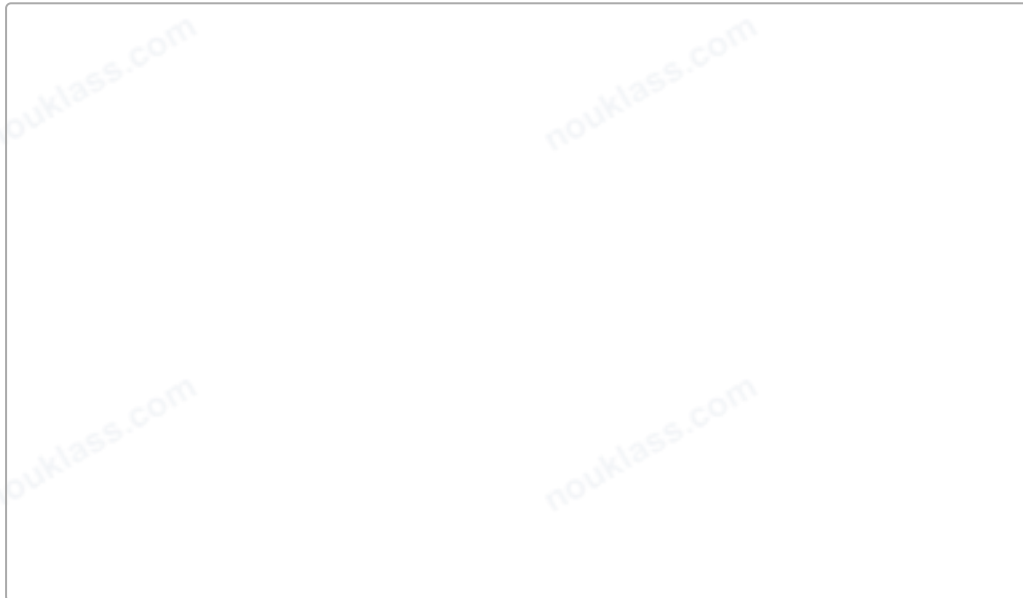
- 12. Write a short paragraph of about 80–100 words about your favourite animal.**

11

Use the points below to help you:

- What is the animal? Where does it live?
- What does it look like? Describe it.
- What does it eat? What is special about it?
- Why do you like this animal?

Marks: Content & ideas (4) | Language & grammar (4) | Spelling & punctuation (3)



Mark Scheme — Grade 5 English Predicted Paper 1

For teachers and parents only. These are indicative answers. Accept reasonable alternatives that show understanding. For writing, use the bands below the table.

Q	Expected Answer	Marks
1	Dolphins use clicks and whistles to communicate. Each dolphin also has its own unique whistle (like a name). Award 1 mark per valid point; max 3.	3
2	A dolphin needs to come to the surface to breathe air because it is a mammal (not a fish). Award 2 marks for including the word 'mammal'; 1 mark for stating it needs to breathe air only.	3
3	When a dolphin is sick, the others stay close and help it reach the surface to breathe. Accept close paraphrase.	3
4	Word: unique . Award 1 mark. Sentence must use 'unique' correctly in context; award 2 marks for a clear, grammatically correct sentence.	3
5	Accept any two reasons from: they are intelligent; they have their own whistle-name; they can leap and spin; they are kind to sick dolphins; they swim alongside boats. 1 mark per valid reason + 1 mark for linking to 'remarkable'.	3
6	(a) an, the (b) The, the (c) an. Award 1 mark per correct pair/answer. Total 5 blanks = 5 marks.	5
7	(a) swam (b) built (c) caught (d) leapt / leaped (e) saw. 1 mark each.	5
8	(a) through (b) under (c) above (d) beside (e) during. 1 mark each.	5
9	(a) smooth (b) dry (c) calm (d) clever (e) remarkable. 1 mark each.	5
10	(a) wild (b) shallow (c) ugly (d) slow (e) weak. 1 mark each.	5
11	(a) surface (b) predator (c) migrate (d) habitat (e) intelligent. 1 mark each.	5
12	See writing bands below.	11
TOTAL		56

Writing bands (Q12):

Aspect	Full marks	Partial	0
Content & ideas (4)	4 points covered, well developed	2–3 points or underdeveloped	Off-topic / nothing written
Language & grammar (4)	Correct tense, varied sentences, no major	Some errors but meaning clear	Very limited language

	errors		
Spelling & punctuation (3)	Mostly correct; full stops and capitals used	Several errors	Very poor